

result when it's done, rather than showing every step.

The gap between "I should kick off that research" and actually being at your laptop disappears. Walking to class or between meetings, you fire off a workflow – pull together background reading on a topic, draft a newsletter, compile a weekly summary – and come back to finished work on the desktop. It's one continuous thread you reach from either device. Worth knowing it's a beta on Pro and Max, needs both the desktop and mobile apps, and your computer has to stay awake for the work to run. And because your phone can now trigger real actions on your machine – moving files, using connected services – only set this up if you're comfortable with what the agent could do, not just what you intend.

Pre-built connectors = no code

Connectors for Google Drive, Microsoft 365, GitHub and others live right in Claude's settings – point-and-click, no development. Custom connectors point to a server reachable over the public internet, which is where dev work comes in, but the common ones are ready out of the box. A few months ago, wiring AI into your own files meant APIs, scripts, and glue code. Now a student

GIVE IT A GOAL
Give Claude a goal and a folder, then walk away while it does multi-step work on your computer. Via Cowork, give it a real outcome ("take these twelve source files and produce a structured report, then organize the folder") and it reads and writes your local files, breaks the job into steps, and returns a finished deliverable – agentic execution on your actual machine, not a chat reply.

can connect their Drive so Claude works across their actual coursework and research folders; a young professional can connect GitHub or their company's Microsoft 365 so answers are grounded in real documents rather than things you paste in. One note on the free tier: connector access is limited compared to paid plans, and Cowork itself (where a lot of this shines) is a paid feature – so check what your plan includes before relying on it.

Install role-based Plugins

In February 2026 Anthropic shipped a free, open-source library of official

"Knowledge Work" plugins on GitHub covering roles like sales, marketing, finance, legal, HR, engineering, design, operations and data analysis, with separate marketplaces for Legal and Financial Services (and Life Sciences). The Knowledge Work marketplace is added in Claude by default; you can browse and install from the Plugins tab. A legal plugin, for example, bundles things like an NDA-review Skill, document-store connectors, and slash commands such as /review-contract.

Rather than building a domain assistant from scratch, you install an experienced-colleague's workflow in one step – and because every plugin is just Markdown and JSON, you can fork it and edit the skill files to match how you work, no engineering required.



Claude inside Office

Via the Microsoft 365 add-in, Claude now works directly within Word, Outlook, Excel and PowerPoint, carrying context across all four – so a redline in Word can flow into a cover note in Outlook without you re-explaining anything. Previously you'd bounce between an AI chat window and your documents, copying back and forth and losing the thread each time. Now the assistance lives where the work already happens – a student can have Claude tighten an essay in Word and then draft the email to a professor in Outlook with the same context; a young professional can analyse figures in Excel and have that carry into the PowerPoint summary. It collapses the copy-paste shuffle between apps into one continuous flow. 

